

China: Unofficial services PMI rose in May

Bottom line:

The headline RatingDog China Services PMI (formerly the Caixin Services PMI) rose to 54.4 in May from 52.6 in April, suggesting service sector activity picked up pace.

Key numbers:

S&P Global services PMI: 54.4 in May (GS forecast: 52.8; Bloomberg consensus: 52.2), vs. 52.6 in April.

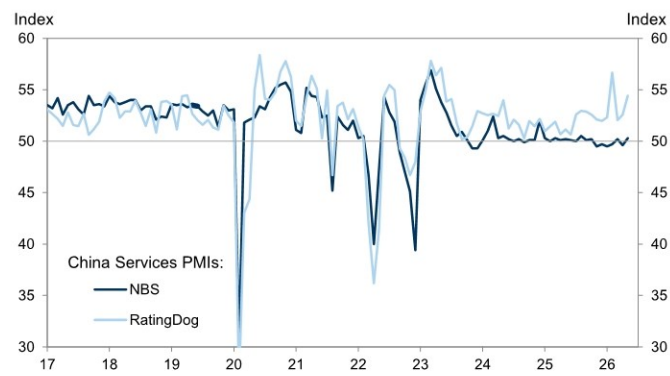
Main points:

1. The RatingDog China services PMI rose to 54.4 in May from 52.6 in April, suggesting service sector activity picked up pace. The new business index increased to 53.3 in May (vs. 52.6 in April), the employment sub-index improved to 50.4 in May (vs. 49.7 in April), and the outstanding business index rose to 51.8 in May (vs. 50.3 in April). The new export orders sub-index rose to 51.5 in May (vs. 49.7 in April). Surveyed companies mentioned that increased client demand, business innovation and expansion, new client acquisitions, improved market conditions and the development of new projects underpinned the latest upturn in new business.
2. Price indicators suggest profit margins remained under pressure. The input prices sub-index rose to 52.0 in May (vs. 51.1 in April), and the output prices sub-index edged up to 49.9 from 49.7 in April. Surveyed companies attributed higher costs to rising oil and fuel prices, increased procurement, and higher wages and other labor costs. Although cost burdens rose, service providers held their charges broadly unchanged in May.

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Both RatingDog and NBS services PMI rose in May



Source: NBS, S&P Global

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